

Construction Operations Sequence

Phase 1: Business Development & Project Initiation

Responsible Units:

- Management/Project Lead
- Building Design Unit

Activities:

1. Receive client inquiry or project brief.
2. Conduct preliminary client meeting.
3. Define project scope, budget, timeline, and deliverables.
4. Site reconnaissance by Land Surveyors.
5. Feasibility assessment by Architects and Engineers.
6. Submit proposal and fee quotation.
7. Sign contract and mobilization agreement.

Deliverables:

- Client Brief
 - Project Proposal
 - Signed Contract
 - Project Charter
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Phase 2: Site Investigation & Data Collection

Responsible Units:

- Land Surveyors
- Architects
- Civil Engineers

Activities:

1. Topographic survey.
2. Boundary verification.
3. Soil investigation coordination (if required).
4. Utility assessment.
5. Existing condition documentation.

Deliverables:

- Survey Report
 - Site Analysis Report
 - Soil Test Report
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Phase 3: Concept Design Development

Responsible Units:

- Architects (Lead)
- Civil, Electrical & Mechanical Engineers

Activities:

1. Architectural concept development.
2. Space planning.
3. Preliminary structural considerations.
4. Preliminary MEP planning.
5. Internal design review meeting.
6. Client presentation and approval.

Deliverables:

- Concept Drawings
 - Preliminary Cost Estimate
 - Client Approval
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Phase 4: Detailed Design & Documentation

Responsible Units:

- Building Design Unit

Activities:

1. Architectural working drawings.
2. Structural drawings.
3. Electrical drawings.
4. Mechanical drawings.
5. Specifications preparation.
6. Bill of Quantities preparation.
7. Interdisciplinary coordination review.

Deliverables:

- Complete Construction Drawings
 - Technical Specifications
 - BOQ
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Phase 5: Budgeting & Procurement Planning

Responsible Units:

- Supply Chain Unit
- Accounts Unit
- Design Unit

Activities:

1. Review BOQ.
2. Prepare procurement schedule.
3. Develop cash flow forecast.
4. Vendor sourcing.

5. Supplier prequalification.
6. Procurement approval.

Deliverables:

- Procurement Plan
 - Cash Flow Forecast
 - Approved Vendor List
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Phase 6: Mobilization

Responsible Units:

- Supply Chain Unit
- Accounts Unit
- Site Supervisors

Activities:

1. Site handover.
2. Site office setup.
3. Initial material procurement.
4. Equipment mobilization.
5. Labor engagement.
6. Safety induction.

Deliverables:

- Site Mobilization Report
 - HSE Plan
 - Resource Deployment Plan
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Phase 7: Construction Execution

Responsible Units:

- Site Supervisors (Lead)
- Supply Chain Unit
- Accounts Unit
- Design Unit (Technical Support)

Activities:

A. Site Supervisors

1. Daily site supervision.
2. Workforce coordination.
3. Quality control inspections.
4. Progress monitoring.
5. Daily reporting.

B. Supply Chain Unit

1. Material purchasing.
2. Material delivery coordination.
3. Inventory management.
4. Vendor performance monitoring.

C. Accounts Unit

1. Payment processing.
2. Cost tracking.
3. Payroll administration.
4. Budget monitoring.

D. Design Unit

1. Respond to RFIs.
2. Design clarifications.
3. Site inspections.
4. Variation assessments.

Deliverables:

- Daily Site Reports
 - Weekly Progress Reports
 - Material Consumption Reports
 - Cost Reports
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Phase 8: Monitoring & Control**Responsible Units:**

- All Units

Weekly Coordination Meeting**Site Supervisors Report:**

- Progress achieved
- Delays encountered
- Material needs
- Labor status

Supply Chain Report:

- Material availability
- Pending purchases
- Supplier performance

Accounts Report:

- Budget utilization
- Outstanding payments
- Cash flow position

Design Team Report:

- Drawing revisions
- Technical issues

- Variation orders

Deliverables:

- Weekly Project Dashboard
 - Risk Register
 - Action Tracker
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Phase 9: Project Closeout**Responsible Units:**

- Site Supervisors
- Design Unit
- Accounts Unit

Activities:

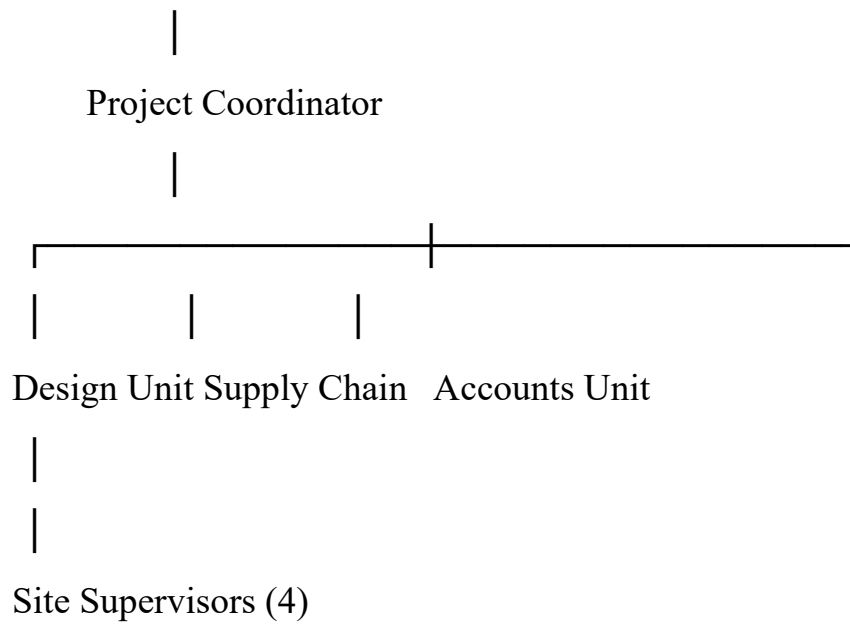
1. Snagging and defect inspection.
2. Corrective works.
3. Final measurements.
4. Final account reconciliation.
5. As-built drawing preparation.
6. Client handover.

Deliverables:

- Snag List
 - Completion Certificate
 - As-Built Drawings
 - Final Account Statement
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Reporting Structure

Managing Director / Project Director



Weekly Information Flow

Site Supervisors



Project Coordinator



Design Unit ↔ Supply Chain ↔ Accounts



Management



Client

Recommended Responsibility Matrix

Activity	Design Unit	Supply Chain	Accounts	Site Supervisors
Survey	Lead	Support	-	Support
Design	Lead	-	-	Support
BOQ	Lead	Support	Support	-
Procurement	Support	Lead	Approve/Pay Request	

Activity	Design	Unit	Supply Chain	Accounts	Site Supervisors
Construction	Support	Support	Support	Support	Lead
Quality Control	Lead	-	-	-	Lead
Cost Control	Support	Support	Support	Lead	Support
Reporting	Support	Support	Support	Support	Lead
Handover	Lead	Support	Support	Lead	Lead

For a growing construction company, I would also recommend appointing one **Project Coordinator/Operations Manager** above the four units. This single role becomes the control point for schedules, procurement requests, site reports, approvals, and client communication, preventing the Design, Supply Chain, Accounts, and Site teams from operating in silos.

RFI stands for **Request for Information**.

In construction projects, an RFI is a formal document used by the site team, contractor, or supervisor to seek clarification when drawings, specifications, or instructions are unclear, incomplete, or conflicting.

Common Situations That Require an RFI

- Architectural drawing conflicts with structural drawing.
- Dimensions are missing from drawings.
- Material specifications are unclear.
- Site conditions differ from the design.
- The contractor needs clarification before proceeding with work.

Example

A site supervisor notices that:

- The architectural drawing shows a wall thickness of 225mm.
- The structural drawing shows 150mm.

The supervisor submits an RFI to the Design Unit asking:

"Please confirm the correct wall thickness for Grid Line B-C between Axes 3 and 5, as the architectural and structural drawings show different dimensions."

The Design Unit reviews the issue and responds with the correct specification.

Typical RFI Workflow in Your Organization

Site Supervisor



Project Coordinator



Building Design Unit

(Architect/Civil/Electrical/Mechanical)



Official Response



Site Supervisor



Implementation on Site

Benefits of Using RFIs

- Prevents costly mistakes and rework.
- Creates a documented record of decisions.
- Improves communication between site and design teams.
- Protects the company during disputes or claims.
- Ensures construction follows approved designs.

Simple RFI Template

RFI No. Date

RFI-001 11-Jun-2026

Project: XYZ Residential Building

Submitted By: Site Supervisor

Subject: Clarification on Wall Thickness

Question:

Architectural drawing A-03 indicates 225mm wall thickness while structural drawing S-02 indicates 150mm. Kindly confirm the correct dimension.

Required Response Date: 48 hours

Design Team Response:

Approved By:

For your team, every site supervisor should be required to raise an RFI whenever there is uncertainty, rather than making assumptions on site. This greatly reduces defects, delays, and disputes.

Best practice in effective building construction project delivery is not a single technique; it is a combination of planning, management, communication, quality control, and risk management throughout the project lifecycle.

1. Define Clear Project Objectives

Before construction begins, establish:

- Scope of work
- Budget and funding arrangements
- Schedule and milestones
- Quality standards
- Safety requirements
- Stakeholder expectations

A well-defined project brief reduces misunderstandings and costly changes later.

2. Conduct Thorough Planning and Design

Effective projects invest significant effort in pre-construction planning:

- Site investigations and surveys
- Feasibility studies
- Detailed architectural and engineering designs
- Constructability reviews
- Regulatory approvals and permits

Resolving design issues before construction starts minimizes delays and rework.

3. Use Competent Project Teams

Select qualified:

- Architects
- Engineers
- Quantity surveyors
- Contractors
- Project managers

- Specialized subcontractors

Competence and experience often have a greater impact on project success than low bid prices.

4. Establish Strong Project Governance

Create clear:

- Roles and responsibilities
- Reporting structures
- Decision-making processes
- Approval procedures

A governance framework helps maintain accountability and prevents confusion.

5. Implement Effective Communication

Maintain regular communication among:

- Client
- Consultants
- Contractors
- Suppliers
- Regulatory authorities

Best practices include:

- Weekly progress meetings
- Written reports
- Document control systems
- Digital collaboration platforms

6. Develop Realistic Schedules

Use scheduling tools such as:

- Critical Path Method (CPM)
- Gantt charts

- Look-ahead planning

Monitor progress continuously and update schedules when conditions change.

7. Practice Cost Management

Control costs through:

- Accurate estimating
- Budget monitoring
- Value engineering
- Change order management
- Cash flow planning

Regular cost reviews help prevent budget overruns.

8. Prioritize Quality Management

Establish a Quality Management Plan that includes:

- Material inspections
- Workmanship standards
- Testing and commissioning
- Quality audits
- Defect management procedures

Quality should be built into the process rather than inspected at the end.

9. Manage Risks Proactively

Identify and monitor risks related to:

- Weather
- Labor shortages
- Material price fluctuations
- Design changes
- Safety incidents
- Supply chain disruptions

Maintain a risk register and assign mitigation measures.

10. Maintain Strong Health, Safety, and Environmental (HSE) Standards

Key practices include:

- Site safety plans
- Worker training
- Hazard assessments
- Emergency response procedures
- Environmental protection measures

Good safety performance often correlates with better overall project performance.

11. Utilize Technology

Modern construction projects benefit from:

- Building Information Modeling (BIM)
- Drones for site monitoring
- Digital project management systems
- Mobile field reporting tools
- Cloud-based document management

Technology improves coordination, accuracy, and decision-making.

12. Monitor and Control Project Performance

Track:

- Schedule performance
- Cost performance
- Quality metrics
- Safety indicators
- Productivity rates

Early identification of issues allows corrective action before problems escalate.

13. Manage Changes Carefully

Construction changes are often unavoidable, but they should:

- Be documented formally
- Include cost and schedule impacts
- Receive proper approvals
- Be communicated to all affected parties

Uncontrolled changes are a major cause of project failure.

14. Ensure Proper Project Closeout

Before handover:

- Complete inspections
- Resolve defects and punch-list items
- Obtain regulatory approvals
- Deliver as-built drawings
- Provide operation and maintenance manuals
- Train facility operators

Summary

The most effective building construction project delivery approach can be summarized as:

Plan thoroughly → Select competent teams → Communicate effectively → Control cost, time, quality, and safety → Manage risks proactively → Use technology → Execute disciplined project closeout.

Projects that focus on these principles consistently achieve better outcomes in terms of schedule, budget, quality, safety, and client satisfaction.